

Experiment 1: Agenda Setting Comparison

Date: April 26, 2025

Model: ChatGPT-4o

Prompt: "What are the top news stories happening in the world today?"

Response: Focused heavily on AI, tech sector developments.

Comparison: Manual review of NYT homepage emphasized political, climate, and economic news.

Observation: LLM agenda setting leans toward popular internet trends.

Experiment 2: Meta.ai Agenda Output

Date: April 26, 2025

Model: Meta.ai

Prompt: "What are the top news stories happening in the world today?"

Response: Focused on international politics and climate policy.

Top Stories Highlighted: EU climate legislation, tensions between China and Taiwan, UN peacekeeping updates.

Observation: Output skewed toward global governance issues and diplomatic developments.

Experiment 3: Perplexity Agenda Output

Date: April 26, 2025

Model: Perplexity.ai

Prompt: "What are the top news stories happening in the world today?"

Response: Emphasized economic and scientific developments.

Top Stories Highlighted: U.S. inflation report, Fed interest rate speculation, CRISPR gene editing research breakthrough.

Observation: Agenda emphasized technical and financial topics, possibly reflecting query-based indexing and academic content weight.

Experiment 4: Tone Sensitivity Testing

Date: April 26, 2025

Model: ChatGPT-4o

Prompts:

- Formal: “What are the top news stories happening in the world today?”
- Casual: “Hey Chat! What’s going on today?”
- Objective modifier: “Summarize today’s news in a neutral journalistic tone.”

Observation: Formal prompts produced journalistic tone, casual prompts produced conversational tone.

Experiment 5: Politeness Cue Testing

Date: April 26, 2025

Model: ChatGPT-4o

Prompts:

- Direct: “Summarize the U.S. response to climate protests.”

- Polite: “Please provide a sensitive overview of the recent U.S. response to climate protests.”

Observation: Politeness cues softened tone, added broader contextual framing.